College of Integrative Sciences and Arts
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Student Showcase

Improving Bookstore Navigation:
A Usability Study at The Bookish Shop

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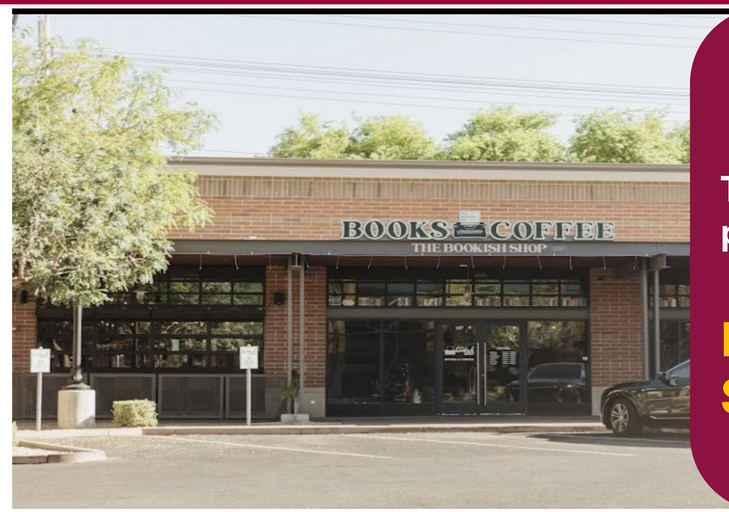
INTRO

The Bookish Shop is a woman-owned romance and fantasy bookstore and café.

The goal in assessing its usability is to identify problem points, and potentially find ways improve this niche business in hopes of retaining its customer base.

This study will evaluate factors such as lighting, layout, and signage.



Key Finding

The most prominent pain point is the

LACK OF CLEAR SIGNAGE

Results

Participants noted the amount of people sitting in chairs reading or working on laptops, expressing an interest in spending time in the establishment beyond the purchasing process. No participants reported issues with the font, but 3/5 requested larger text.

METHODS

Task based testing

- How long it takes to find a specific title
- Observe where test subjects get stuck
- Think-aloud protocol where subjects narrate their thoughts as they browse

Participants:

- 18-year-old female
- 21-year-old female
- 24-year-old female
- 24-year-old female
- 23-year-old female

Results: Observations

Relied heavily on walking not signage

Participants 1 and 4 reported confusion about the genre of contemporary.

Browsed based on title and genre rather than author.

Conclusion

Overall, the layout of the store is effective. The atmosphere is conducive to buying while still having a welcoming environment where patrons can linger without obligation. The font of the signage is effective, but the placement, wording, and size of the text can be improved.